

Market Viability & Self-Serve Go-to-Market Report

A focused strategy for launching OARFlow as a low-touch, self-serve SaaS for solo and very small (1–3 person) pest-control operators — pest-first, with a staged path into adjacent home-service verticals.

Date	June 27, 2026
Prepared for	Jake (OARFlow founder / product)
Supersedes	"OARFlow Market Viability, GTM, Pricing & Differentiation Report" (June 22, 2026)
Focus shift	From founder-led pest SaaS for 1–20 techs → self-serve, near-zero-touch product for solo / 1–3 tech operators
Scope	Readiness correction, low-end market sizing, competitive set, pricing, product-led GTM, unit economics, roadmap, risks

Evidence & currency note

Competitor prices, A2P messaging fees, and industry stats are current to sources accessed **June 27, 2026** and can change quickly; figures are cited in Appendix E.

Unlike the prior report, the OARFlow product-readiness assessment here is derived from **direct inspection of the codebase** (routes, libraries, migrations, go-live docs), not a supplied description. Reddit/review signals remain directional, not statistically representative.

ARPA, churn, and spend figures are **planning assumptions, not forecasts**.

Self-serve PLG · Solo / 1–3 techs · Pest-first · Free tier + transparent pricing · Product is largely built · Activation & retention > features

1. Executive Summary

Bottom line: targeting solo and very small operators is the right call — not because the segment is richer, but because the **hurdle to entry is dramatically lower**. Solo owners buy in days, not quarters; they don't run procurement, demand integrations, or need enterprise dispatch. And OARFlow is unusually well-positioned to serve them, because the product is **already broad**: booking, invoicing, recurring plans, two-way SMS, quotes, reviews, a field PWA, reporting/exports, a customer portal, and a pest compliance pack are all built. The gap is not features — it's that onboarding is still a human, command-line process. The work is to turn a feature-complete product into a **self-serve** one and to win on **activation, transparency, and retention**.

This reframes the prior report in three ways. First, it **corrects product readiness upward** (most of what that report scheduled to "build" already ships). Second, it swaps an expensive **founder-led sales motion for a product-led one** sized to a ~\$70 blended ARPA. Third, it is honest that the low end trades a lower acquisition hurdle for **lower ARPA and higher churn** — so the entire operating model is built around fast time-to-value and keeping customers.

The five highest-impact moves

#	Move	Why it wins at the low end	Proof OARFlow can do it
1	Make it self-serve — public signup, automatic tenant provisioning, a 10-minute setup wizard, and OARFlow's own plan billing.	Self-serve is the entire low-end motion. At \$29–\$79/mo you cannot afford to hand-onboard each customer.	Tenant model, per-tenant settings, and a <i>new-tenant</i> script already exist; they need a public signup + wizard wrapped around them.
2	Free tier + transparent pricing with essentials ungated (reminders, reviews, reports, exports).	ServiceM8's free/pay-as-you-go and the distrust of "call-for-pricing" tools are the clearest low-end openings.	SMS, reviews, reporting, and exports are built, so OARFlow can include them cheaply where rivals gate them.
3	Migration as a self-serve product — CSV / QuickBooks customer & recurring import with validation.	Switching friction is the #1 reason small owners stall. Self-serve import removes the human bottleneck.	CSV/exports and the data model exist; a guided <i>import</i> wizard is the missing half.
4	Field app + SMS at low tiers as the visible differentiator.	Mobile reliability and texting are what owners feel daily; rivals charge up-market for them.	Field PWA (photos/signature/materials/offline-lite) and two-way SMS already ship.
5	Retention system — activation milestones, annual prepay, product-led virality.	Low-end churn (3–5%/mo) is existential; retention, not acquisition, decides whether this works.	Recurring plans, customer data, and customer-facing pages create natural lock-in and a viral surface.

Recommended sequence

- **Phase 0 — make it self-serve (0–60 days).** Public signup → auto-provision, setup wizard, OARFlow plan billing (free/Starter/Pro), Stripe connect, booking embed snippets, import v1, "Powered by OARFlow" on public pages.
- **Phase 1 — activation & acquisition (60–150 days).** Migration v2, in-app onboarding checklist + templates, A2P sole-proprietor SMS streamlining, SEO/content + marketplace listings, referral loop.
- **Phase 2 — expand & retain (4–9 months).** Lead capture/pipeline, QuickBooks Online live sync, annual-prepay incentives, and template packs for adjacent verticals (lawn, cleaning, pool).
- **Phase 3 — widen the moat (9–18 months).** AI receptionist add-on, deeper state compliance, integrations/marketplace, and an optional white-label/reseller channel once self-serve onboarding is proven.

2. What Changed Since the June 22 Report

The earlier report scored OARFlow's **product readiness 6.5/10** and described it as "missing SMS, mobile field ops, quotes, reporting exports, QBO, and compliance," then laid out a three-phase plan to build those. That report explicitly noted its product read came from a supplied description, "not independent inspection." Inspection of the codebase shows most of that surface is **already implemented**. This changes the strategy: the job is to package and sell what exists, not to build it again.

Already built vs. genuinely open (from the codebase)

Capability	Status in code	Implication
Booking (instant + request), availability/capacity	Built — <i>public.js, availability.js</i>	Core wedge ready
Invoicing, ledger, Stripe pay page, recurring plans	Built — <i>invoices.js, recurring.js, pay</i>	Lead-to-cash core ready
Two-way SMS, reminders, on-my-way	Built — <i>sms.js, notify_sms.js, sms_webhook</i>	Include low; don't "build"
Quotes / estimates with online approval	Built — <i>estimates.js, quotes.js</i>	Differentiator vs cheap tools
Mobile field PWA (photos, signature, materials, offline-lite)	Built — <i>field.js, /field</i>	Visible field differentiator
Reviews / NPS	Built — <i>reviews.js</i>	Growth lever ready
Reporting + CSV/PDF, accounting CSV/IIF export	Built — <i>reports.js, accounting.js</i>	"Useful reports" claim is real
Customer portal, documents/e-sign, devices/QR, commissions	Built — <i>portal/documents/devices/commissions</i>	Beyond solo needs already
Pest compliance-lite (EPA/chemical, service reports, state export)	Built — <i>compliance.js</i> , migration 0019	Pest credibility ready
Public API v1 + signed outbound webhooks (Zapier/Make)	Built — <i>api_v1.js, webhooks.js</i>	The rank-#12 "build later" already ships
Named dispatch / route board / route optimization	Built — <i>technicians/routing</i>	Reserve for higher tier
Self-serve signup + tenant provisioning	Gap — CLI <i>new-tenant.js</i> only	The #1 build for this strategy
OARFlow's own plan billing / metering / trials	Gap — Stripe bills tenants' customers, not OARFlow's plans	Required to monetize self-serve
Self-serve CSV/QuickBooks import & migration	Gap — export strong, guided import weak	Removes switching friction
Lead capture / pipeline / source attribution	Gap — no module	Real gap; Phase 2 for solo
QuickBooks Online <i>live sync</i> (vs export)	Partial — export + QBO-ready interface	Phase 2
AI phone receptionist	Scaffold only	Phase 3 add-on; buy, don't build

Net effect on the plan

Roughly two-thirds of the prior "roadmap" already exists. So Phase 1 is **harden + remove activation friction**, not build. Revised readiness for the **solo/1–3 tech self-serve wedge** is **~8.5/10** on product, gated by one thing: there is no self-serve front door yet.

Usefully, the human onboarding runbook drafted earlier (website integration, DB/tenant setup, webhooks) is effectively the **spec for the self-serve wizard** — productizing that runbook is Phase 0.

3. Market Viability for the Low-End Wedge

The low end is attractive for one reason above all: **access**. Solo and 1–3 tech owners make fast, individual decisions and are reachable through search, communities, and word of mouth without a sales team. The honest tradeoff is that they pay less and churn more, so viability depends on cheap acquisition and strong activation — not on the raw size of the prize.

Revised viability scorecard

Dimension	Score	Reasoning for a self-serve, solo-first motion
Access / low hurdle	9/10	Individual owners, no procurement; reachable via SEO, marketplaces, communities, referrals. This is the thesis.
Product readiness	8.5/10	Nearly everything a solo operator needs is built; only the self-serve front door and import are missing.
Buyer pain	8/10	QuickBooks/paper workarounds, missed leads, no-shows, clunky mobile, basic reports — well documented for 1–10 tech firms.
Willingness to pay	6/10	Real but thin at solo level (\$0–\$79/mo expectations). Monetize via tiers + usage, not high seats.
Market size (pest-only, low end)	5.5/10	Modest: solo/small pest software is low-tens-of-\$M ARR at full capture. A beachhead, not the whole prize — expansion required.
Churn risk	5/10	Self-serve SMB churn runs 3–5%/mo; solo operators also go out of business. The central risk.
Competitive intensity	6/10	GorillaDesk, Jobber, HCP, ServiceM8 all have low tiers; win on fit, transparency, and bundled essentials.
Overall	7.5/10	Viable and lower-risk to <i>enter</i> than the broad play; success hinges on activation + retention, then vertical expansion.

Honest TAM / SAM / SOM at low-end ARPA

Layer	Definition	Sizing	Notes
TAM	U.S. pest-control firms that could run software	~16,565 firms (NPMA 2025). At ~\$80/mo blended, full capture ≈ \$16M ARR for pest software overall.	Small for a single vertical — by design the entry point, not the ceiling.
SAM	Solo / 1–2 location pest firms (81.4% of the market) reachable self-serve	~13,500 firms. Realistic serviceable value in the low-tens-of-\$M ARR .	The self-serve sweet spot; least-served by enterprise tools.
SOM (24 mo)	Self-serve sign-ups that activate and pay	200–1,500 paying customers → ~\$0.17M–\$1.26M ARR at \$70 ARPA.	Driven by funnel + churn control, not headcount.
Expansion	Adjacent home-services (lawn, cleaning, pool, handyman)	Multiplies addressable firms 10–50× with the same product + new templates.	The actual path past a few \$M ARR; pest proves the motion.

Why pest-first still makes sense: recurring revenue is 85.4% of residential pest revenue and 81.4% of firms run one or two locations (NPMA 2025) — a population of small, recurring-route operators that maps directly onto OARFlow's strengths. Pest also gives credible language and a compliance angle. But the sizing makes clear that **vertical expansion is not optional** for an outcome beyond a few million ARR; it is the plan.

4. The Self-Serve Buyer and What They Actually Need

The target is an owner-operator or a 2–3 person shop running on QuickBooks, a calendar, spreadsheets, paper tickets, and manual texts — or paying for a broad tool whose useful features sit a tier or two above what they bought. They evaluate software at night, on their phone, between jobs. If they cannot reach value alone in one sitting, they churn before they pay.

What they need first (and what they don't)

They need now	Why	They do NOT need yet
A booking link / page they can share and embed	Replaces phone-tag; works on whatever website they have	Multi-branch, complex dispatch boards
Invoices + get paid (card/cash/check)	Cash flow is the felt problem	Job costing, payroll, financing
Recurring plans & auto-generated visits	Pest is recurring; manual re-entry is the pain	Named-tech self-booking
Text reminders + review requests	Cuts no-shows; drives Google reviews	AI receptionist / call center
A simple mobile day sheet (photos, signature)	Field trust; proof of service	Offline conflict-resolution depth
Import my customers without a human	Switching friction is the deal-killer	White-glove data migration

The activation bar to design against

"From signup to a live booking link, a sent invoice, and an imported customer list in **under 10 minutes, with no call.**" Every Phase 0 decision should be measured against that sentence.

5. Competitive Landscape at the Low End

Going down-market changes the competitive set. ServiceTitan, FieldRoutes, and PestPac are no longer the field; the relevant rivals are low tiers of SMB tools, plus "QuickBooks + paper" and website-builder booking. Prices below are official/public list as of June 2026 (Appendix E) and move often.

Competitor	Entry price (2026)	Model notes	Where OARFlow wins
GorillaDesk	Basic \$49 / Pro \$99 / Growth \$299	Pest-specific; priced by routes; unlimited admin users; SMS add-on \$5/mo + credits; 14-day trial	Free tier; bundle SMS/reviews/field app lower; faster setup
Jobber	Core \$39 (\$28 annual, 1 user) / Connect \$119 / Grow \$199	Broad home-service; per-user above tiers; generic, not pest-first	Pest recurring routes + compliance; no per-user tax at low tiers
Housecall Pro	Basic \$79 (\$59 annual, 1 user) / Essentials \$189 / Max \$329	Basic omits QuickBooks & GPS — real entry is ~\$149+; +\$35/user	Transparency: don't gate QBO export/reports; unlimited users
ServiceM8	Free tier; Starter ~\$29 / Growing \$79 / Premium \$149	Priced by jobs not users; pay-as-you-go SMS; 50% off 12 mo for new biz	Match free + PAYG, add pest depth + recurring routes ServiceM8 lacks
FieldPulse / Kickserv	~\$49–\$60 solo (FieldPulse unpublished)	FieldPulse hides pricing (friction); Kickserv cheap but thin	Published pricing; more built-in (field app, compliance, reviews)
"QuickBooks + paper" / Wix-Square booking	\$0–\$30 effective	The real default for the smallest operators; no routes/field/compliance	The "first real system" step-up — import from QB, keep accounting

The openings, concretely

- **Free + transparent** beats "call for pricing" (FieldPulse) and the gated-Basic trap (Housecall Pro's \$79 Basic without QBO/GPS).
- **Unlimited users / not-per-seat** matters for owner+spouse+seasonal-helper shops (mirrors ServiceM8/GorillaDesk; punishes Jobber/HCP up-tier).
- **Bundled essentials:** SMS, reviews, a real field app, and exports are *included low* because they're already built — rivals push these up-tier or to add-ons.
- **Pest depth at a solo price:** recurring routes + compliance-lite that generic cheap tools (Kickserv, Wix) simply don't have.

6. Differentiation Strategy

Recommended positioning: **"The first real operating system for a one-truck pest business — booking, texts, invoices, routes, and service reports you can set up yourself in ten minutes, free to start."**

Pillar	What it means in product	Why it is defensible
1. Self-serve in minutes	Public signup, auto-provisioned tenant, guided wizard, instant booking link	Sales-led incumbents can't easily copy a true free, self-serve front door culturally
2. Already-built breadth at a solo price	SMS, quotes, reviews, field PWA, reports, compliance included low	Marginal cost to include is ~zero for OARFlow; rivals monetize these up-tier
3. Transparent, ungated essentials	Published pricing; reminders, reports, exports, QBO export not gated	Directly attacks HCP's Basic trap and "request pricing" friction
4. Own-your-data + easy switch	Self-serve import; one-click export guarantee	Removes the switching fear that stalls small buyers
5. Pest-first, vertical-ready	Recurring routes + compliance-lite; settings/templates per vertical	Beats generic cheap tools now; same engine expands later
6. Product-led virality	"Powered by OARFlow" on booking/pay/review pages (off on paid)	Every tenant markets to their own customers — cheap distribution

Taglines to test

- "Run your one-truck pest business from your phone — free to start."
- "Booking, texts, invoices, and routes. Set it up yourself in ten minutes."
- "The step up from QuickBooks and paper — without enterprise pricing."

7. Pricing and Packaging

Design rules for the low end: a **genuinely useful free tier** for acquisition and virality; **unlimited users** (price on value/usage, not seats); **essentials ungated**; and **usage-based pass-through** for SMS/AI so thin margins stay honest. Anchor below Housecall Pro's real entry and beside Jobber Core / GorillaDesk Basic, while including more.

Plan	Price (mo / annual)	Target	Included	Excluded / up-tier
Free	\$0	Solo just starting; acquisition + virality	Booking page/link, up to ~30 active jobs/mo, manual invoices, customer pay page, 1 user. "Powered by OARFlow".	SMS, recurring automation limits, field app, removal of badge
Starter	\$29 / \$24	One-truck operator leaving QB + paper	Everything in Free + unlimited jobs, recurring plans, email reminders, basic reports, CSV import/export, full pay page, unlimited users	Two-way SMS usage, named dispatch, compliance pack
Pro	\$79 / \$66	1–3 tech shop wanting a real OS	Starter + two-way SMS (usage), quotes/estimates, reviews/NPS, field PWA, photos/e-sign, portal, PDF reports, accounting export	Route optimization, QBO live sync, full compliance, API
Growth	\$149 / \$129	3–8 techs graduating up	Pro + named dispatch/route board, compliance pack, device QR, commissions, granular roles, public API/webhooks, priority support	AI receptionist, high-volume SMS (usage)

Add-ons and policy

Add-on	Recommendation	Guardrail
SMS / MMS	Pass-through carrier cost + small markup or credit bundles; streamline A2P 10DLC sole-proprietor registration (\$4.50 brand) in onboarding	Never advertise "unlimited"; log consent/opt-out; quiet hours
AI receptionist	Phase 3; \$99–\$299/mo base + usage; buy the engine	Recording consent, escalation rules, no legal/pesticide promises
Migration	Self-serve CSV/QBO import free; \$199–\$999 only for legacy/custom jobs	Publish scope; export guarantee if they leave
Extra storage	Generous base; \$5–\$15/mo for large media archives	Per-tenant retention + export/delete controls

Blended ARPA model (paying customers)

Plan	Price	Assumed mix (of payers)	Weighted
Starter	\$29	35%	\$10.15
Pro	\$79	45%	\$35.55
Growth	\$149	20%	\$29.80
Avg SMS/add-on	~\$8	—	\$8.00
Blended ARPA			≈ \$83/mo (model at \$70 to stay conservative)

Free users are excluded from ARPA; they are an acquisition and virality channel that converts at a single-digit percentage into Starter/Pro. The conservative \$70 planning ARPA absorbs heavier Free/Starter mix and annual discounts.

8. Self-Serve Go-to-Market

At ~\$70 ARPA there is no budget for founder-led selling as the primary motion; acquisition must be product-led and content-driven, with CAC held well under one churn-adjusted lifetime of gross profit. A light, founder-assisted onboarding for the first cohort is fine to *learn* — then remove it.

The funnel and the channels

Channel	Play	Cost posture	Risk / note
SEO & content	"GorillaDesk/Jobber/HCP alternative," "QuickBooks pest-control scheduling," "free pest-control booking page," how-to + switching guides	Low, compounding	Slow to start; needs credible, sourced comparisons
Free tools / lead magnets	Pesticide log template, route-profit calculator, review-request generator, QB import checklist	Low one-time	Caveat compliance state-by-state
Marketplaces / review sites	Capterra, GetApp, SoftwareAdvice, G2 (self-serve, after 20–50 reviews); Stripe/QuickBooks app directories	Medium, high intent	Burns budget without strong onboarding/reviews
Product-led virality	"Powered by OARFlow" on customer-facing booking/pay/review pages	~Free	Keep tasteful; remove on paid
Referral loop	"Give a month, get a month"; in-product prompts after activation	Low (margin share)	Only after activation is reliable
Communities	Helpful presence in r/pestcontrol, r/smallbusiness, owner Facebook groups	Founder time	Must be useful, not spammy
Paid search (later)	Long-tail pain + retargeting only once CAC payback is proven	Capped test	Generic FSM keywords are expensive; stay long-tail

Launch offer & first 180 days

- **Offer:** "Start free. Import your customers, share your booking link, and send your first invoice today — upgrade when it's making you money." Annual prepay gets two months free (churn defense).
- **Days 1–60:** ship self-serve; recruit 10–20 design users at Starter/Pro for weekly feedback; instrument activation.
- **Days 60–120:** publish comparison/switching content + free tools; list on 2–3 marketplaces; turn on referral; first case studies.
- **Days 120–180:** double down on the 1–2 channels with the best CAC payback; begin lawn/cleaning template packs to widen the funnel.

9. Unit Economics and Spend-to-Revenue

Assumptions: blended ARPA **\$70/mo**, gross margin **80%** (gross profit $\approx$ **\$56/mo**), self-serve SMB benchmarks of CAC payback **8–12 months healthy** and monthly logo churn **3–5%** (Appendix E). These are planning figures, not guarantees.

CAC payback & LTV sensitivity

Blended CAC	Payback (months)	Churn 3%/mo → LTV	Churn 5%/mo → LTV	Read
\$150	2.7	\$1,848	\$1,120	Excellent — organic/referral/virality
\$250	4.5	\$1,848	\$1,120	Healthy self-serve target
\$400	7.1	\$1,848	\$1,120	Acceptable if churn $\leq$ 4%
\$600	10.7	\$1,848	\$1,120	Ceiling; only with annual prepay + low churn
\$900	16.1	—	—	Too high for the low end

LTV = monthly gross profit $\div$ monthly churn. At CAC \$250, LTV:CAC is $\sim 4.5\text{--}7.4\times$ — comfortably above the $3\times$ rule. The lever that matters most is churn, not CAC.

Spend-to-revenue scenarios (at \$70 ARPA)

Revenue target	MRR	Paying customers	Cash to acquire base (CAC \$150–\$400)	Likely motion
\$120k ARR	\$10k	~ 143	$\sim \$21k\text{--}\$57k$	Content/SEO + virality + referral; founder-led design cohort
\$300k ARR	\$25k	~ 357	$\sim \$54k\text{--}\$143k$	+ marketplaces, free tools, light paid tests
\$600k ARR	\$50k	~ 714	$\sim \$107k\text{--}\$286k$	+ scaled content, referral engine, retargeting
\$1.0M ARR	\$83k	$\sim 1,190$	$\sim \$179k\text{--}\$476k$	Repeatable PLG + measured paid + vertical expansion

Cash-to-acquire excludes founder time and the (largely fixed) content/tooling base; it also excludes the ongoing spend needed to **replace churned logos** ($\sim 3\text{--}5\%$ /mo of the base). Even so, these totals are far below a founder-/field-sales motion — the point of going self-serve.

Retention is the whole game

At 5%/mo churn you lose $\sim 46\%$ of logos a year; at 3% you lose $\sim 31\%$. The difference decides whether acquisition compounds or treads water. Levers: (1) **activation milestones** (first booking, first invoice sent, first import) in the first session; (2) **annual prepay** incentives; (3) **data & workflow lock-in** (their customers, recurring routes, and history live in OARFlow); (4) **usage habit** (texts/reviews running automatically). Track and attack churn from day one.

10. Product Roadmap for Self-Serve Entry

Because the feature surface is largely built, this roadmap is ordered by what unlocks self-serve revenue and retention — not by feature count. The first phase is almost entirely about the **front door**.

Phase	Build	Why now
0 — Self-serve front door (0–60d)	Public signup → automatic tenant provisioning (productize <i>new-tenant.js</i>); 10-minute setup wizard (profile, hours, services, branding, connect Stripe, get booking link/embed); OARFlow plan billing (free/Starter/Pro via Stripe Billing, limits + SMS metering, trials, dunning); import v1; "Powered by OARFlow" badge	Nothing sells self-serve without this; it converts a built product into a business
1 — Activation & acquisition (60–150d)	Migration v2 (QuickBooks/CSV with validation/dedupe); in-app onboarding checklist + empty-state templates; A2P sole-prop SMS streamlining; SEO/content + marketplace listings; referral loop	Turns sign-ups into paying, retained customers and starts cheap acquisition
2 — Expand & retain (4–9 mo)	Lead capture/pipeline + source attribution; QuickBooks Online live sync; annual-prepay incentives; adjacent-vertical template packs (lawn, cleaning, pool)	Lifts ARPA/retention and widens the funnel beyond pest
3 — Widen the moat (9–18 mo)	AI receptionist add-on (buy engine); deeper state compliance templates; integrations/marketplace; optional white-label/reseller channel	Premium expansion + a channel, once self-serve onboarding is proven

Do not rebuild what ships

SMS, quotes, reviews, the field PWA, reporting/exports, compliance-lite, named dispatch/routing, the customer portal, and the public API/outbound webhooks are already implemented. Treat them as **packaging and tier-placement decisions**, not engineering work.

11. Risks, Constraints, and Operating Model

Risk	Why it matters	Mitigation
Low-end churn	3–5%/mo erodes the base; solo owners also close shop	Activation milestones, annual prepay, lock-in via data/recurring, dunning, win-back
Self-serve support load	Many tiny accounts; support can swamp thin margins	In-app guidance, templates, docs/video, community; reserve human help for paid tiers
SMS / A2P compliance	Texting without consent/registration risks deliverability + legal exposure; T-Mobile raised pass-through Jan 2026	Consent + opt-out logging, quiet hours, streamlined sole-prop A2P, transparent pass-through
Thin SMS / AI margins	Usage COGS can erase plan margin if bundled	Pass-through + small markup or credits; never "unlimited"
Review-policy violations	Google bans incentives, gating, and pressure	Neutral requests to all eligible customers; no incentives; no rating-gated redirects
Free-tier abuse / low intent	Free can attract non-buyers and cost	Sensible job/feature caps; nudge to value; badge drives virality to offset
Payment lock-in backlash	Owners fear processor/account holds	Keep BYO-Stripe; offer platform processing as an option, not a requirement
Pesticide-compliance overpromising	State rules vary; false claims = legal risk	Ship records/exports, not legal guarantees; disclaimers; expert review per state
Vertical-expansion dilution	Chasing verticals too early weakens the pest wedge	Templates/settings only; don't fork the product; expand after pest activation is proven

Operating metrics to track from day one

Metric	Target / signal	Why
Time to first booking link live	< 10 minutes from signup, no call	Self-serve activation proxy
Time to first invoice sent	< first session / 24h	Proves revenue value fast
Time to first import	< 1 day, self-serve	Measures switching friction
Free → paid conversion	Single-digit % of free; 10–25% of trials	Core PLG efficiency
Gross logo churn	< 4%/mo, trending down	The existential low-end metric
CAC payback	< 12 months (aim < 6)	Determines if acquisition scales
Net revenue retention	≥ 100% via upgrades/usage	Expansion offsets churn

Appendix A — Self-Serve Onboarding Wizard (the Phase 0 spec)

This is the single most important build. It productizes the human onboarding runbook into a guided flow. Each step maps to capabilities that already exist in the codebase.

Step	What the owner does	Behind the scenes
1. Sign up	Email + business name + vertical (pest)	Create account; auto-provision tenant (API version of <i>new-tenant.js</i>); pick slug
2. Business basics	Timezone, hours/capacity, branding (logo text, color)	Write <i>tenants.settings</i> (branding/availability already supported)
3. Services & prices	Add/confirm services from pest templates	Seed <i>service_types</i> / presets (demo seed logic exists)
4. Get paid	Connect Stripe (Connect or keys)	Per-tenant encrypted Stripe (already supported)
5. Texting (optional)	Enable SMS; one-tap A2P sole-prop registration	Twilio per-tenant; streamline \$4.50 brand flow
6. Import customers	Upload CSV / QuickBooks export; map & dedupe	New guided importer over existing customer model
7. Go live	Copy booking link or embed snippet; choose pick: link / subdomain / iframe	Booking flow + embed options already exist (from the runbook)
8. Pick a plan	Stay Free or upgrade; badge toggle on paid	New OARFlow plan billing + metering

Appendix B — Build vs. Buy

Capability	Recommendation	Note
Self-serve signup/provisioning	Build	Wrap the existing tenant model; core to the strategy
OARFlow plan billing/metering	Build on Stripe Billing	Distinct from tenants' own Stripe; needed to monetize
CSV/QuickBooks import wizard	Build	Switching friction is the deal-killer
SMS delivery	Buy (Twilio), build workflow	Carrier compliance is specialized; workflow is native (built)
AI receptionist	Buy engine, build workflow	Fast-moving, high-risk; Phase 3
QBO live sync	Build direct	Export ships; live sync is Phase 2
Reviews/NPS, field PWA, reports, compliance	Already built	Package and tier; do not rebuild

Appendix C — SEO / Page Map for Self-Serve

Page	Intent	CTA
/free-pest-control-software	Free-tool seekers	Start free
/gorilladesk-alternative	Comparison shopper	Compare + start free
/housecall-pro-alternative-pest	Gated-pricing frustration	See transparent pricing
/quickbooks-pest-control-scheduling	QuickBooks workaround	Import checklist + start free
/pest-control-booking-page	Booking-link seekers	Make your booking page
/free-pesticide-usage-log-template	Compliance template	Download + start free
/route-profit-calculator	Operational ROI	Save report + start free

Appendix D — Key Assumptions

- Blended paying ARPA \$70/mo (conservative vs. ~\$83 modeled); gross margin 80%.
- Monthly logo churn 3–5%; CAC payback target < 12 months (aim < 6).
- Free tier converts single-digit % to paid; trials 10–25%.
- Pest-first; adjacent verticals via templates from Phase 2.
- Product-readiness from codebase inspection (June 2026); competitor prices are public list and volatile.

Appendix E — Source List

#	Source	Used for
1	NPMA, "U.S. Pest Control Industry Sustains Steady Growth with 6% Increase in 2025"	16,565 firms; 81.4% 1–2 locations; 85.4% recurring; 13.29M residential customers; 36.8% tech-constrained; 109,384 techs
2	Pest Control Technology, "U.S. Structural Pest Control Market Crosses \$13 Billion Mark"	Structural market size context
3	GorillaDesk Pricing (official + Capterra/GetApp 2026)	Basic \$49 / Pro \$99 / Growth \$299; route-based; SMS add-on; trial
4	Jobber Pricing (getjobber.com, 2026)	Core \$39 (\$28 annual) / Connect \$119 / Grow \$199; per-user above tiers
5	Housecall Pro Pricing (housecallpro.com, 2026)	Basic \$79/\$59 / Essentials \$189/\$149 / Max \$329/\$299; Basic omits QBO/GPS; +\$35/user
6	ServiceM8 Pricing (servicem8.com, 2026)	Free tier; Starter ~\$29 / Growing \$79 / Premium \$149; per-job; PAYG SMS; 50% off 12 mo
7	FieldPulse / Kickserv pricing roundups (2026)	Solo entry ~\$49–\$60; FieldPulse unpublished pricing
8	Twilio A2P 10DLC Pricing & Fees (help.twilio.com, 2026)	Sole-prop brand \$4.50; standard \$44; campaign \$15 + \$1.50–\$10/mo; carrier surcharge \$0.003–\$0.005/msg; T-Mobile Jan-2026 increase
9	Self-serve SMB SaaS benchmarks (2026 roundups)	CAC payback 8–12 mo healthy (sub-\$15k ACV); monthly logo churn 3–5% typical
10	OARFlow codebase (routes, lib, db/migrations, GOING_LIVE.md, ARCHITECTURE.md)	Product-readiness inventory: built vs. gaps

Prepared June 27, 2026. Pricing, fees, and forum/review signals change; verify before publishing public comparisons. ARPA, churn, CAC, and spend figures are planning assumptions, not forecasts or guarantees.